

TidyTuesday Week 40

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Thursday 1st October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back, dear reader, to the only weekly newsletter that treats a random number generator and a federal economic database like a dating app. This week we swiped right four times and, as always, the results were a glorious monument to coincidence. Buckle up.

Monday served us the matchup of the century: Great Lakes wood product manufacturing versus mobile phone subscriptions across Europe and Central Asia. Because of course those two belong in the same regression. The raw version basically shrugged – nothing significant, an R-squared you could trip over – but then, plot twist, the detrended version actually coughed up a significant negative relationship. So after we strip out each series' own march through time, apparently fewer Great Lakes two-by-fours quietly coincide with more European cell phones, or vice versa. Is there a mechanism here? Absolutely not. Did it survive the detrending gauntlet? Weirdly, yes, which in this project is practically a standing ovation, even if what we're clapping for is almost certainly noise in a trenchcoat.

Tuesday brought the week's big flashy number: labor-force-nonparticipation among Black Americans against a discontinued measure of the wage share of national income, posting an R-squared of 0.89 in the raw regression. Point eight nine! Pop the champagne, call the Nobel committee, we've cracked macroeconomics! Except, as our heroic detrended check reminds us, two series that both drift majestically over decades will hold hands no matter what, and once we remove those trends the relationship deflates from "0.89 soulmates" to a much more modest 0.23. Still technically significant, sure, but this is the textbook trend-mirage – the kind of raw hit that looks like destiny and is really just two lines going the same direction for eighty years. Wednesday did the same thing in reverse: intellectual-property import charges versus durable-goods consumption share looked impressively significant raw, then collapsed into total nothingness once detrended (p-value of 0.44, the statistical equivalent of a blank stare). Classic.

Thursday, mercifully, declined to participate in any drama whatsoever: government receipt imputations versus discontinued U.S. official reserve assets produced a p-value of 0.83 raw and an even more apathetic 0.53 detrended. Two series that looked at each other, felt absolutely nothing, and went home. Honestly refreshing. As ever, the standard disclaimer applies with great enthusiasm: these are randomly paired series, there is no theory here, no causal claim, and no reason to believe any of it. Spurious correlation isn't the risk in this project – it's the entire business model. See you next week, when we'll once again mistake two upward-sloping lines for love.

2 Date: 2026-09-28

Series ID: GLAKWPMANRGSP

This series is titled Real Gross Domestic Product: Wood Product Manufacturing (321) in the Great Lakes BEA Region and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Millions of Chained 2017 Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1997-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ITCELSETSP2ECS

This series is titled Mobile Cellular Subscriptions: All Income Levels in Europe and Central Asia and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number per 100 People and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ITCELSETSP2ECS	R-squared:	0.083
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.048
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.357
Date:	Mon, 28 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.137
Time:	18:50:21	Log-Likelihood:	-142.11
No. Observations:	28	AIC:	288.2
Df Residuals:	26	BIC:	290.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	285.3207	123.888	2.303	0.030	30.665	539.976
value_fred_GLAKWPMANRGSP	-0.0407	0.026	-1.535	0.137	-0.095	0.014

Omnibus:	3.492	Durbin-Watson:	0.174
Prob(Omnibus):	0.174	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.983
Skew:	-0.713	Prob(JB):	0.225
Kurtosis:	2.275	Cond. No.	7.63e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 7.63e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

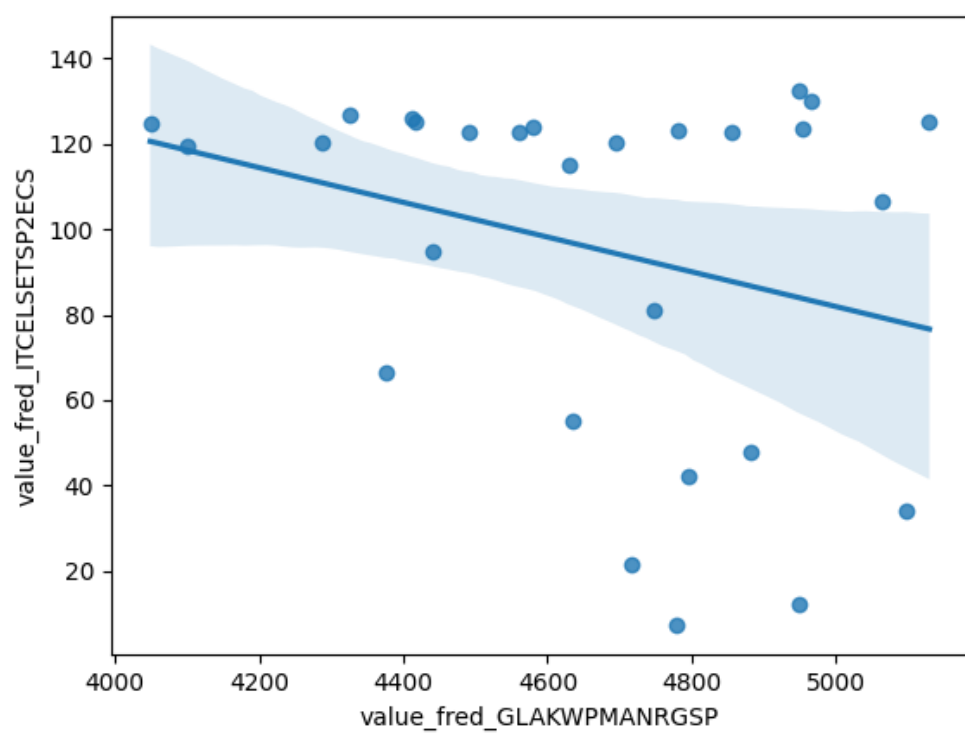


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-28

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ITCELSETSP2ECS_detrended	R-squared:	0.184
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.152
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	5.853
Date:	Mon, 28 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0228
Time:	18:50:21	Log-Likelihood:	-119.03
No. Observations:	28	AIC:	242.1
Df Residuals:	26	BIC:	244.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	1.116e-12	3.330	3.35e-13	1.000	-6.845	6.845
value_fred_GLAKWPMANRGSP_detrended	-0.0283	0.012	-2.419	0.023	-0.052	-0.004

Omnibus:	0.861	Durbin-Watson:	0.444
Prob(Omnibus):	0.650	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.837
Skew:	0.216	Prob(JB):	0.658
Kurtosis:	2.272	Cond. No.	285.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

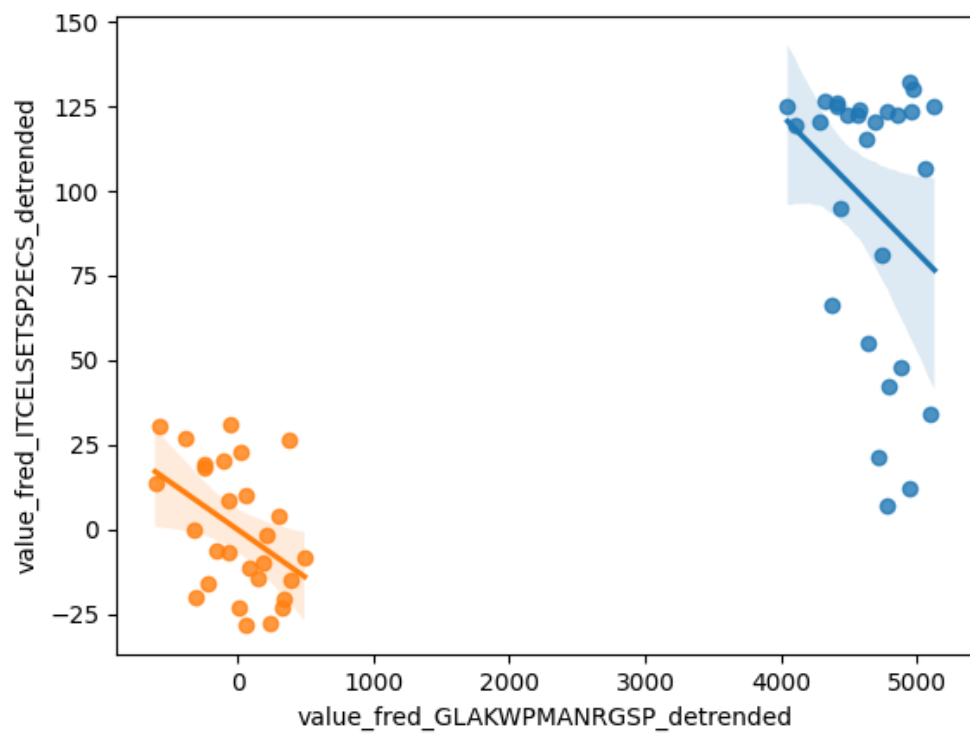


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-28

3 Date: 2026-09-29

Series ID: W269RE1A156NBEA

This series is titled Shares of gross domestic income: Compensation of employees, paid: Wage and salary accruals: Disbursements (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2011-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: LNU05000006

This series is titled Not in Labor Force, Black or African American and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1972-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_LNU05000006	R-squared:	0.886			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.883			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	295.5			
Date:	Tue, 29 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.63e-19			
Time:	17:07:32	Log-Likelihood:	-300.21			
No. Observations:	40	AIC:	604.4			
Df Residuals:	38	BIC:	607.8			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	3.833e+04	1754.440	21.850	0.000	3.48e+04	4.19e+04
value_fred_W269RE1A156NBEA	-632.0219	36.768	-17.190	0.000	-706.454	-557.590
Omnibus:	2.321	Durbin-Watson:	0.414			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.313	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.433			
Skew:	0.178	Prob(JB):	0.488			
Kurtosis:	2.143	Cond. No.	1.17e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.17e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

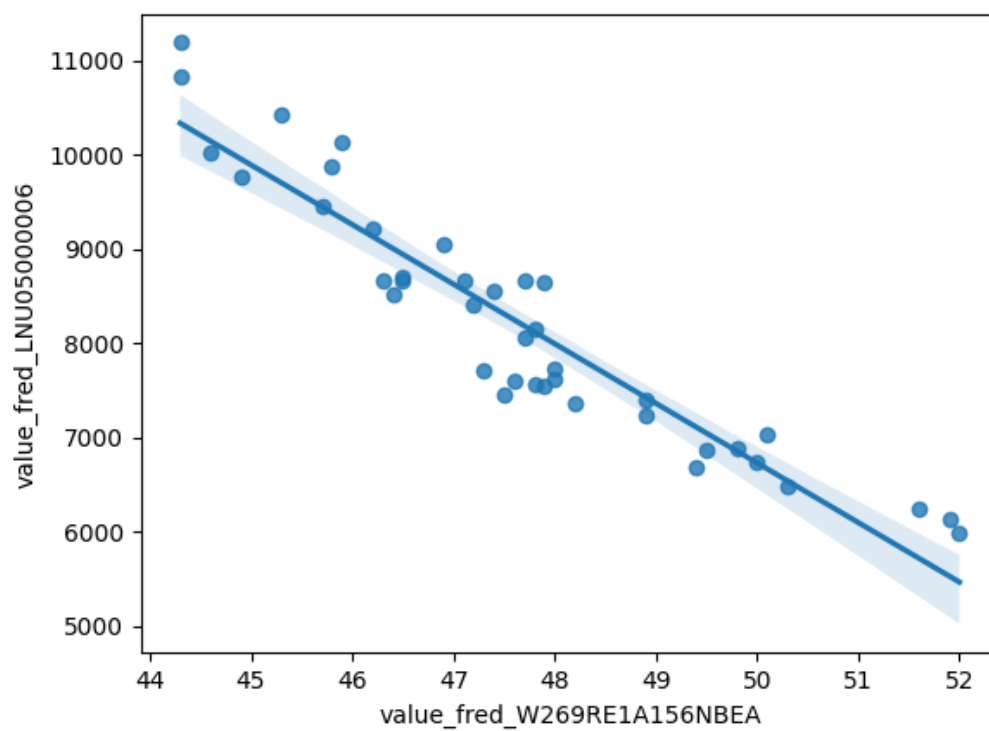


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-29

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_LNU05000006_detrended	R-squared:	0.229
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.209
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	11.29
Date:	Tue, 29 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00178
Time:	17:07:32	Log-Likelihood:	-275.80
No. Observations:	40	AIC:	555.6
Df Residuals:	38	BIC:	559.0
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.404e-11	38.755	1.14e-12	1.000	-78.455	78.455
value_fred_W269RE1A156NBEA_detrended	-174.7065	51.991	-3.360	0.002	-279.957	-69.456

Omnibus:	8.056	Durbin-Watson:	0.312
Prob(Omnibus):	0.018	Jarque-Bera (JB):	6.850
Skew:	0.862	Prob(JB):	0.0325
Kurtosis:	4.067	Cond. No.	1.34

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

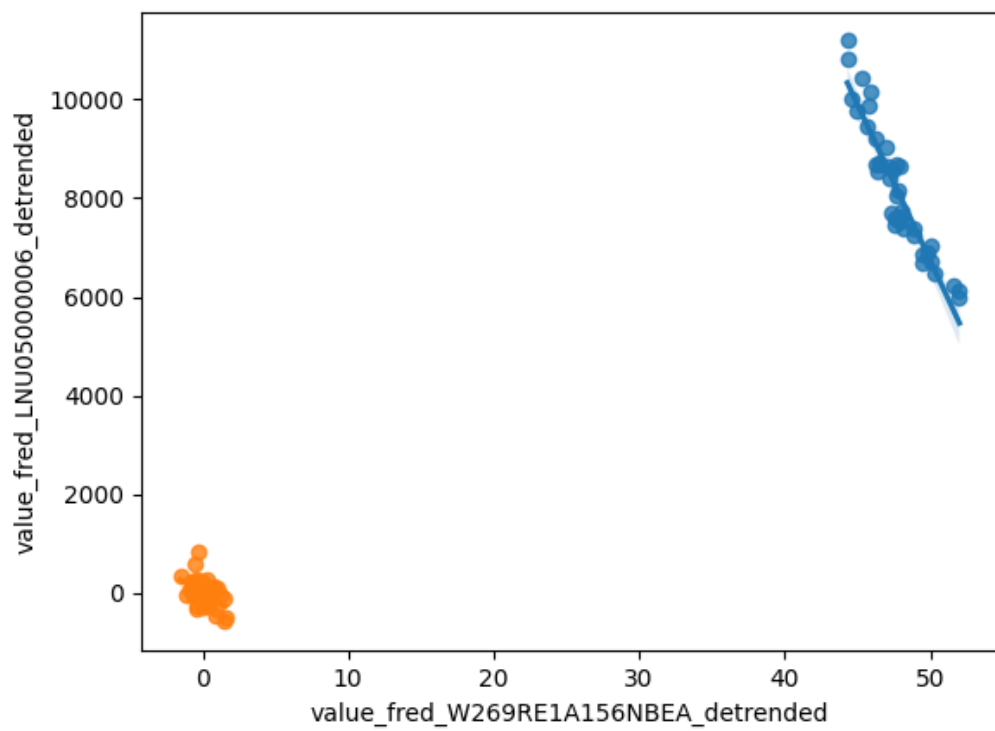


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-29

4 Date: 2026-09-30

Series ID: IEAMSIPN

This series is titled Imports of Services: Charges for the use of intellectual property n.i.e. and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1999-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: DDURRE1A156NBEA

This series is titled Shares of gross domestic product: Personal consumption expenditures: Durable goods and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Percent and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDURRE1A156NBEA	R-squared:	0.321
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.294
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	11.82
Date:	Wed, 30 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00206
Time:	17:05:45	Log-Likelihood:	-25.239
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	54.48
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	57.07
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	8.7930	0.314	28.002	0.000	8.146	9.440
value_fred_IEAMSIPN	-0.0001	3.39e-05	-3.438	0.002	-0.000	-4.67e-05

Omnibus:	5.919	Durbin-Watson:	0.272
Prob(Omnibus):	0.052	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.819
Skew:	0.005	Prob(JB):	0.403
Kurtosis:	1.729	Cond. No.	2.36e+04

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.36e+04. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

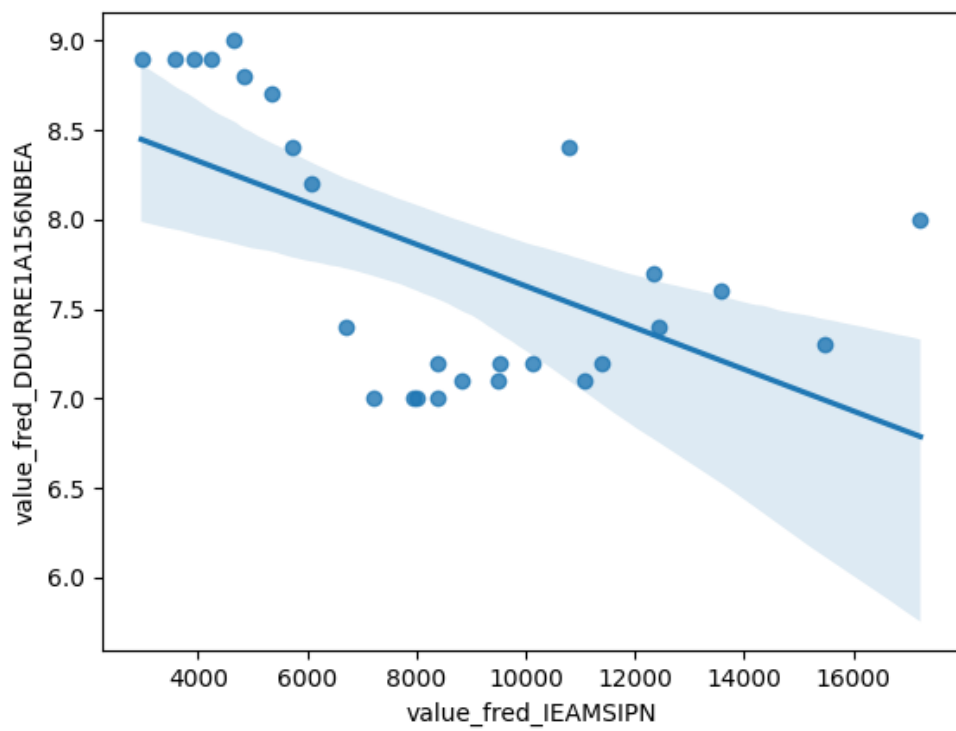


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-30

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_DDURRE1A156NBEA_detrended	R-squared:	0.024
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.015
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.6106
Date:	Wed, 30 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.442
Time:	17:05:45	Log-Likelihood:	-23.256
No. Observations:	27	AIC:	50.51
Df Residuals:	25	BIC:	53.10
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	6.162e-14	0.115	5.38e-13	1.000	-0.236	0.236
value_fred_IEAMSIPN_detrended	8.159e-05	0.000	0.781	0.442	-0.000	0.000

Omnibus:	0.623	Durbin-Watson:	0.358
Prob(Omnibus):	0.732	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.652
Skew:	-0.067	Prob(JB):	0.722
Kurtosis:	2.250	Cond. No.	1.10e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.1e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

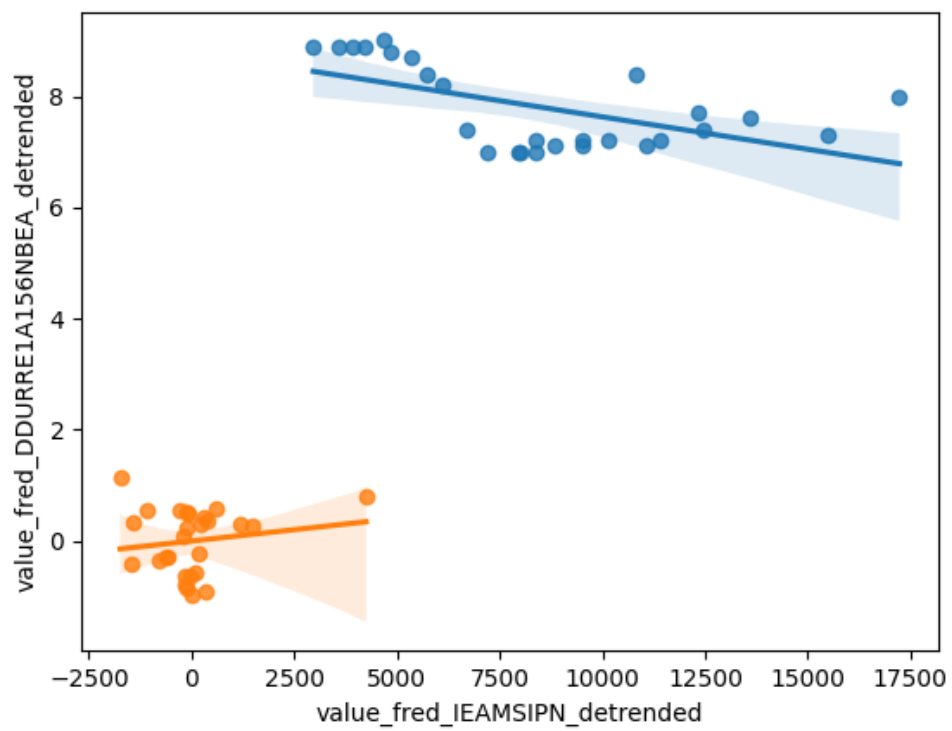


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-30

5 Date: 2026-10-01

Series ID: W568RC1A027NBEA

This series is titled Government current receipts: Imputations and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1929-01-01 and the observation end date is 2022-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BOPOON

This series is titled U.S. Official Reserve Assets Abroad, Net (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2014-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOPOON	R-squared:	0.001
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.018
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.04727
Date:	Thu, 01 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.829
Time:	19:55:13	Log-Likelihood:	-112.57
No. Observations:	55	AIC:	229.1
Df Residuals:	53	BIC:	233.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-0.2012	0.458	-0.439	0.662	-1.119	0.717
value_fred_W568RC1A027NBEA	-0.0115	0.053	-0.217	0.829	-0.117	0.094

Omnibus:	6.566	Durbin-Watson:	1.473
Prob(Omnibus):	0.038	Jarque-Bera (JB):	10.848
Skew:	0.067	Prob(JB):	0.00441
Kurtosis:	5.172	Cond. No.	15.6

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

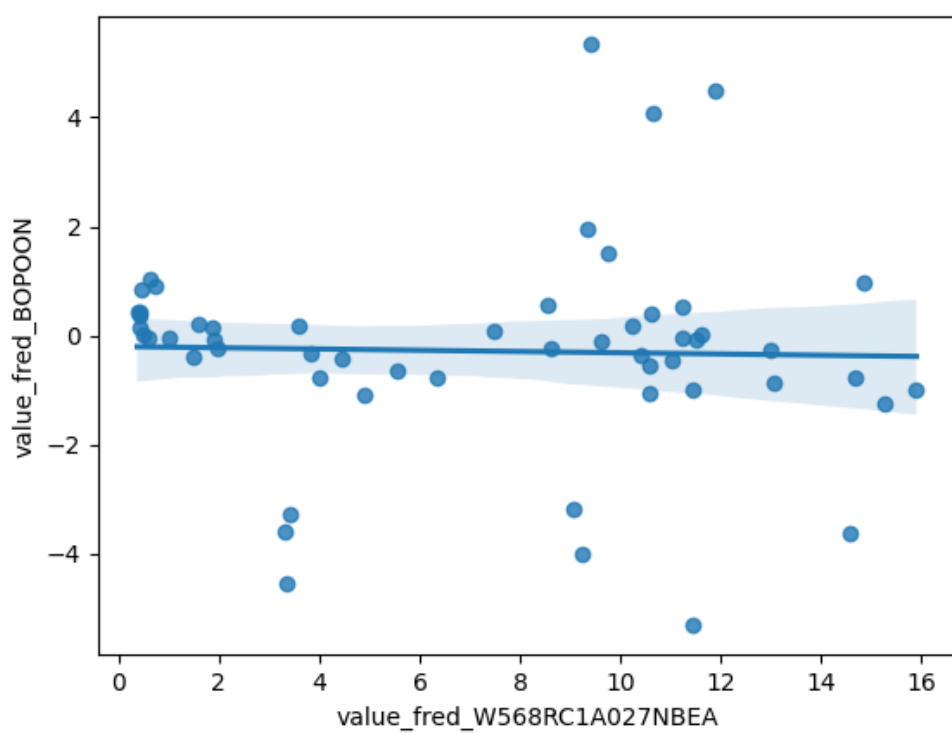


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-01

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BOPOON_detrended	R-squared:	0.007
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.011
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.3913
Date:	Thu, 01 Oct 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.534
Time:	19:55:13	Log-Likelihood:	-112.39
No. Observations:	55	AIC:	228.8
Df Residuals:	53	BIC:	232.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.084e-14	0.256	-4.22e-14	1.000	-0.514	0.514
value_fred_W568RC1A027NBEA_detrended	-0.1030	0.165	-0.626	0.534	-0.433	0.227

Omnibus:	5.994	Durbin-Watson:	1.499
Prob(Omnibus):	0.050	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.174
Skew:	0.019	Prob(JB):	0.0102
Kurtosis:	5.000	Cond. No.	1.56

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

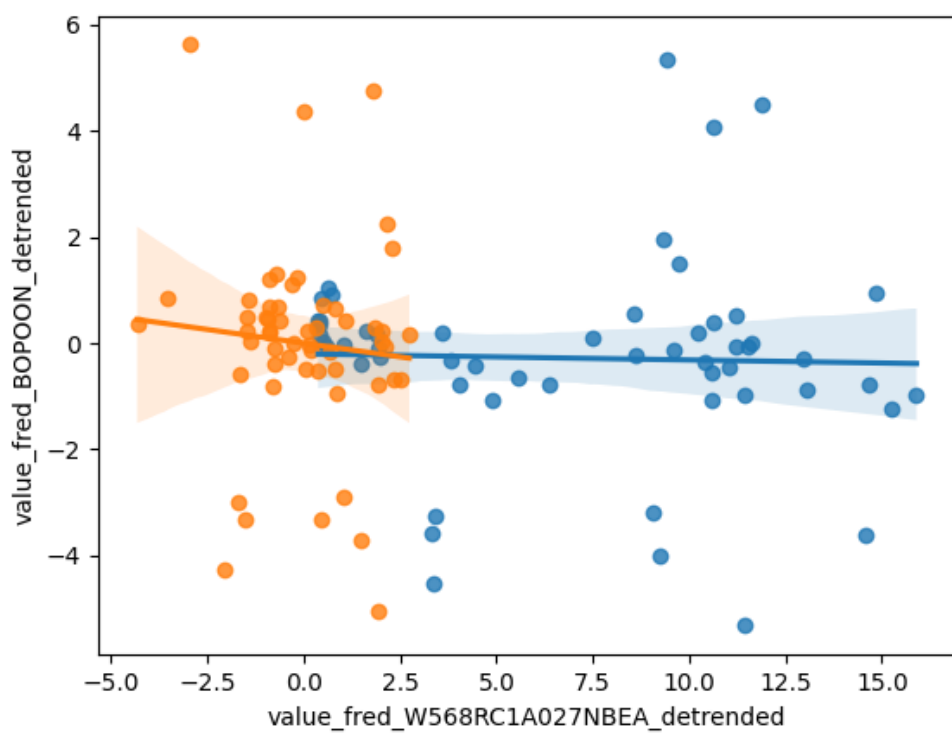


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-01